

50

custom prompt
templates, ready to
paste and adapt

Custom Prompt Templates to Automate Your Weekly Workflow

A practical PDF for turning repetitive weekly work into a repeatable AI-assisted system. No hype. Just prompts you can use today.

FIFTY PROMPT TEMPLATES

Custom Prompt Templates to Automate Your Weekly Workflow

Written for solo operators, technical teams, and anyone who has just started working alongside an AI assistant and wants the weekly grind to shrink.

Surajit Chatterjee

FIRST EDITION

CONTENTS

—	How to use this book	4
	Brackets, context, and the two-minute edit	
ONE	Administrative & Email Automation	5
	Templates 1–10	
TWO	High-Speed Content Creation	9
	Templates 11–20	
THREE	Research & Data Analysis	13
	Templates 21–30	
FOUR	Strategy & Brainstorming	17
	Templates 31–40	
FIVE	Technical: Coding & Architecting AI Solutions	21
	Templates 41–50	
—	Writing template fifty-one	25
	Turning a good answer into a permanent one	

How to use this book

Every template here is written to be pasted whole. Anything in [square brackets] is yours to swap: a paste of your notes, a name, a date, a number. Change the brackets, send the prompt, then edit the answer rather than the question.

You do not need to read this in order, and you certainly do not need all fifty. Skim the part that matches the work in front of you, take two templates, and use them for a week before adding more.

The line under each title tells you when the template earns its keep. If that line does not sound like your week, skip it without guilt. Fifty is a menu, not a checklist.

GIVE IT THE RAW MATERIAL

Paste the messy source before the instruction. Most disappointing answers are starved answers, not stupid ones.

KEEP YOUR CORRECTIONS

When you fix the same thing twice, write the fix into the template. That is the moment these become yours.

Administrative & Email Automation

The small stuff eats the week. These ten hand the sorting, chasing and replying to your assistant so your attention goes somewhere better.

01 Inbox to action list

For the morning you have read everything and done nothing.

Read these messages: [paste]. Give me a table of action, owner and deadline. Put things waiting on me at the top and things I am waiting on at the bottom.

02 The weekly status note

For the update you rewrite from scratch every Friday.

Turn my notes [paste] into a status update for [recipient]: shipped, in flight, blocked, and what I need from them. Under 150 words, no filler.

03 Reply in my own voice

For when drafts come back sounding like a press release.

Here are three emails I wrote: [paste]. Match that voice and draft a reply to [message]. Keep my sentence length and skip anything I would never say.

04 Notes to decisions

For meetings that end without anyone owning anything.

From these notes [paste], list decisions made, actions with an owner and a date, and open questions. Flag anything discussed but never decided.

05 Agenda in ten lines

For the recurring meeting that has lost its point.

Write an agenda for a [length] meeting on [topic]. Every item needs a decision and a time box. End with the one question we must answer before leaving.

06 Chasing, warmly

For the third follow-up you would rather not send.

This thread has gone quiet: [paste]. Write a short nudge that restates what I need and by when, gives them an easy out, and does not sound passive-aggressive.

07 Saying no, kindly

For the request you should decline but keep saying yes to.

Decline this request [paste] without damaging the relationship. Give the real reason in one line, offer one alternative, and keep it under 80 words.

08 Calendar defence

For the week that is booked before it begins.

Here is my calendar: [paste]. Flag meetings that could be a written update, and any day with no unbroken hour for real work. Suggest what to move.

09 Onboarding the small ask

For requests you send often to different people.

I ask people for [thing] most weeks. Write a reusable message with clearly marked blanks, a one-line why, and a version for someone who has never met me.

10 Your reply library

For the ten questions you answer over and over.

Here is a month of my sent mail: [paste]. Find the questions I answer repeatedly and write a saved reply for each, in my voice, with the variable parts marked.

High-Speed Content Creation

Drafting is the slowest part of most weeks and the easiest to share. Ten templates for getting to a real first version fast, then making it sound like you.

11 Outline before drafting

For the blank page that has beaten you twice already.

I need to write [piece] for [reader]. Propose three possible structures, one sentence each, and tell me which suits a reader who is skimming.

12 Bullets to first draft

For notes that have been sitting in a doc for a week.

Turn these bullets [paste] into a [length] draft. Keep my points and order. Where a claim needs evidence I have not given, mark it rather than inventing it.

13 Voice match

For copy that has to sound like the rest of your work.

Study this writing sample: [paste]. Describe its voice in five rules, then rewrite [text] to follow them.

14 Cut it by a third

For anything too long to be read by the person who matters.

Cut this by a third without losing meaning: [paste]. Show the shorter version first, then list what you removed so I can argue with you.

15 One piece, three channels

For work that deserves more than one outing.

From this piece [paste], write a short post, an email intro, and a five-line summary for chat. Same argument, different attention span.

16 Titles worth choosing between

For when the first headline is always the one you keep.

Give me ten titles for [piece]: plain, curious, specific and blunt versions. No colons, no wordplay. Then tell me which two you would test.

17 Doc to slide story

For the deck due tomorrow that lives inside a long document.

Turn this document [paste] into a slide narrative: one headline sentence per slide, in order, plus the single chart or example each slide needs.

18 FAQ from real questions

For the same five questions arriving from five people.

Here are real questions people asked: [paste]. Group them, write a plain answer for each in under 60 words, and note which answers need a decision from me first.

19 Make it a template

For a document you have now written three times.

Here are three examples of [document type]: [paste]. Extract the shared structure into a reusable template with prompts for each section and a filled example.

20 The line edit

For the last pass before you press send.

Line edit this [paste] for clarity only. Do not change my argument or vocabulary. Show edits as a list of before and after so I can accept them one by one.

Research & Data Analysis

Use these to think with, not to be told what to think.
Every one of them asks for uncertainty to be shown
rather than smoothed away.

21 Scope the question first

For research that sprawls because nobody framed it.

I want to understand [topic] to decide [decision]. Before answering, ask me the five questions that would most change your approach.

22 Source triage

For the twelve tabs you have not read yet.

Summarise each source [paste] in three lines: its central claim, the evidence behind it, and how confident I should be. Note where two sources disagree.

23 Competitive scan

For the quarterly look at what everyone else is doing.

Compare [competitors] on [dimensions] using only what I paste here: [material]. Mark anything you are inferring rather than reading.

24 Numbers to narrative

For the dashboard nobody wants to interpret.

Here is this week's data: [paste]. Write four sentences on what changed, what likely caused it, what to watch, and what you cannot tell from this data alone.

25 Find the odd one out

For numbers that look fine until someone asks a question.

Scan this data [paste] for anomalies: sudden changes, impossible values, gaps. For each, suggest whether it is more likely a real event or a collection problem.

26 This week against last

For the weekly comparison you rebuild by hand.

Compare these two periods [paste]. Show absolute and percentage change, order by size of change, and say which differences are too small to mean anything.

27 Themes in open text

For survey answers and support tickets nobody has read.

Group these responses [paste] into themes. Give each a name, a count, and two verbatim quotes. Keep a bucket for responses that fit nowhere.

28 What does this metric mean

For the number two teams calculate differently.

Here is how we define [metric]: [definition]. List the edge cases it does not cover and the behaviours it would reward if people optimised for it.

29 Argue with my analysis

For conclusions you want tested before a room tests them.

Here is my analysis and conclusion: [paste]. List the assumptions it rests on, the strongest counter-reading of the same data, and what evidence would settle it.

30 Two hundred words for a busy reader

For the summary that decides whether anyone reads the rest.

Compress this report [paste] to 200 words for [reader]: finding, evidence, recommendation, risk. Lead with the finding, not the method.

Strategy & Brainstorming

Thinking partners are rare and expensive. These ten templates make a decent one available at eleven at night, provided you keep the final say.

31 Ten options, quickly

For when you have one idea and no comparison.

Give me ten ways to [goal], given [constraints]. Include two that are cheap and unglamorous and two that would be uncomfortable to propose.

32 Steelman the other side

For a plan everyone in the room already agrees with.

I plan to [plan]. Make the strongest possible case against it, as a smart colleague would, then tell me which objection I should actually act on.

33 Pre-mortem

For the launch that has to go right.

It is [date] and [project] has failed. Write the five most plausible explanations, then the cheapest thing I could do this week to prevent each.

34 Down to the real cause

For a problem that keeps coming back wearing a new hat.

Problem: [describe]. Ask me why five times, one question at a time, waiting for my answer before the next. Then summarise the cause you land on.

35 The one-page decision brief

For a decision that needs someone else's yes.

Turn this into a one-page brief: [context]. Sections: the decision, the options, the recommendation, what we give up, and what would change our mind.

36 Trade-offs on one screen

For three good options and no obvious winner.

Compare [options] in a table against cost, time, risk and reversibility. Add a row for what each option assumes about the future.

37 Rehearse the objections

For the pitch or review you are nervous about.

You are [audience] hearing this proposal: [paste]. Ask me your six hardest questions one at a time, and tell me afterwards which answer was weakest.

38 Narrow the field

For a brainstorm that produced thirty ideas and no plan.

Here are our ideas: [paste]. Propose three scoring criteria that fit our situation [context], score every idea, and show the top five with reasons.

39 Quarter goal to this week

For goals that are true in January and forgotten by March.

My quarterly goal is [goal] and here is my week: [paste]. Name the three outcomes that move it most, and say plainly what I give up to get them.

40 What happens next

For changes whose side effects arrive a month later.

If we do [change], what happens in a week, a quarter and a year? Include effects on people whose work I am not thinking about.

Technical: Coding & Architecting AI Solutions

For the weeks when you are building the thing rather than writing about it. Assume every answer is a draft until a test agrees with it.

41 Explain this code to me

For inherited code with no author left to ask.

Walk me through this code [paste]: what it does, its inputs and outputs, and the three places a change is most likely to break something.

42 Tests before code

For a feature whose edge cases you have not thought about yet.

I am building [feature] with [stack]. Write the test cases first, including empty, malformed and concurrent input, before writing any implementation.

43 Review my change

For the pull request you would rather not embarrass yourself with.

Review this diff [paste] as a careful senior engineer. Separate correctness bugs from style opinions, and put the two things I must fix at the top.

44 Debug by hypothesis

For the bug you have been guessing at for an hour.

Symptom: [describe]. Code and logs: [paste]. List five hypotheses ranked by likelihood and the cheapest test to eliminate each. Do not suggest a fix yet.

45 Three architectures, honestly

For the design decision you will live with for two years.

I need to build [system] under [constraints]. Propose three architectures, from boring to ambitious, with the failure mode and operational cost of each.

46 Spec an AI feature

For the moment someone says we should add AI to it.

We want an AI feature that [goal]. Write the spec: the job it does, its inputs, what a good output looks like, how it fails, and what happens when it does.

47 Prompt, retrieval or fine-tune

For choosing the approach before spending a month on it.

My use case is [describe] with [data]. Compare prompting, retrieval and fine-tuning for it on cost, latency, maintenance and how wrong they go.

48 A way to tell if it works

For prompts shipped on the strength of one good demo.

Here is my prompt and its job: [paste]. Design an evaluation: twenty test inputs including nasty ones, what a pass looks like, and how I would score it weekly.

49 Where it should refuse

For anything customers will touch unsupervised.

For this feature [describe], list the inputs it should refuse, the answers it must never give, and what the user sees when the model is unsure.

50 Improve the prompt itself

For the prompt that works four times out of five.

Here is my prompt and a weak answer it produced: [paste]. Diagnose which instruction failed, rewrite the prompt, and explain each change in one line.

Writing template fifty-one

The fifty in this book are a starting stock, not a finished set. The ones you will actually keep are the ones you write yourself, usually by accident, on an ordinary afternoon when an answer comes back better than expected.

When that happens, stop and save the prompt before you move on. Strip out the specifics, put brackets where the specifics were, and write one line underneath about when to reach for it. That is the whole method.

Do that four or five times and you will have a library shaped exactly like your work, which is worth considerably more than fifty templates shaped like everyone's.

Here is a prompt that worked well and the answer it gave: [paste both]. Turn it into a reusable template with the variable parts in brackets, and add one line on when it is the right tool.